



WHALE CLASS · AMS MONTESSORI · BEIJING

Circle Time Guide

Everything you need, one page per day.

Week 6 · Healthy Food

“Crunch! Every Day or Sometimes?” · Monday 12 – Friday 16 October 2026
13 minutes a day · ages 2.5–6, English learners

Some food is for **every day** and some food is only for **sometimes** —
and the best food is the food you share. 重阳节 falls at the end of this week.

🌿 Week Overview

Print · laminate · ring-bind · hold this all week.

Five words they'll own by Friday

healthy

water

crunchy

sweet

share

Littles (2.5–3) — one word + a gesture is a win: **“Crunchy!”** (huge bite, then CRUNCH with the whole body), **“Water!”** (drink from a cup, long “aaah”), **“Share!”** (hold it out with both hands).

Bigs (4–6) — sentence frames: **“An apple is healthy.”** · **“Sweets are sometimes food.”** · **“I share my food with my friend.”** · **“I can ____!”**

The 13-minute flow — the same every day

- **2 min · Magic Box hook** — box chant → shake → sniff → dramatic peek → the day's real object.
- **4 min · Teach** — the day's word with the real food in your hand. Get it wrong once on purpose so they can correct you.
- **3 min · Song** — chorus → today's new verse → chorus.
- **3 min · Game** — one named game, tied to the day's word.
- **1 min · Close** — whisper → louder → loudest.

The Magic Box, day by day

- **Mon** — a washed apple and a lollipop, side by side.
- **Tue** — a bottle of water and a bottle of fizzy drink, with the sugar cubes counted out and stacked beside the fizzy one.
- **Wed** — the crunchy tray: celery, carrot, cucumber, apple. Snap each one, loudly.
- **Thu** — an empty lunchbox. We pack it together, one food from each of last week's five groups.
- **Fri** — 重阳糕, a chrysanthemum, a walking stick for 登高, and every prop from the week.

Theme shelf · four trays

- **1 · Every day / sometimes sorting** — a green plate, a yellow plate, twenty food cards. *Control:* a green or yellow dot on the back of every card.
- **2 · Sugar-cube counting** — five bottles, a dish of cubes, a numbered card each. *Control:* the number card face-down under the bottle.
- **3 · Apple slicing** — wedger, board, jug of water, serving dish. Cut it, then offer a piece to someone else. *Control:* eight equal pieces; the board is wiped dry.
- **4 · 古诗对应汉字** — 《九月九日忆山东兄弟》 on one long card with loose tiles 九 · 月 · 山 · 兄 · 花. *Control:* the whole poem card underneath.

MONDAY · Every Day or Sometimes?

Today's words: healthy

Grab: one washed **apple** and one **lollipop** in the Magic Box; two hoops (or a green plate and a yellow plate); the 12 food cards from print pack page 14; a tea towel to wipe the apple.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Box chant. Shake it — something *rolls* and something *rattles*. Two things! Sniff the lid.

EVERYONE “What's in the box? What's in the box?”

Peek. Gasp. Peek again. Lift out the apple in one hand and the lollipop in the other and hold them far apart.

TEACHER “Two foods. One is for **every day**... and one is only for **sometimes**.” (*look from one hand to the other, very slowly*)

Polish the apple on your jumper. **“Apple!”**

4 MIN TEACH · HEALTHY

Apple up high, in two hands, so every child can see it.

An apple is **healthy**. (*hold it up*)

Healthy food makes me **strong**. (*strong arms, growl*)

I eat it **every day**. (*five fingers, one at a time*)

CRUNCH! (*take a huge bite — let them hear it*)

Now the lollipop. Hold it up the same way, wait, and let them tell you. **“Every day? ... or sometimes?”**

Little's say the one word **“Healthy!”** with strong arms — a full win at 2 and 3. Bigs say the frame: **“An apple is healthy.”** and **“Sweets are sometimes food.”**

Teacher fails: announce that the lollipop is “a lovely **healthy** breakfast”, start unwrapping it and look delighted. Do not rush. Let them shout you down twice before you sadly put it away.

3 MIN GAME · EVERY DAY OR SOMETIMES?

“One, two, three — eyes on me!” Two hoops on the carpet: a **green** one — *every day* — and a **yellow** one — *sometimes*. Cards face down in a pile. **“Take a card. Run it to the right hoop!”**

Each child takes one card, names it, and puts it in a hoop. The class calls the verdict together: **“Every DAY!”** or **“Sometimes.”** Twelve cards, so everyone gets a turn or two. Bigs owe you a sentence — **“Broccoli is healthy.”** Little's just run and drop, and shout with the class.

1 MIN CLOSE

EVERYONE “Healthy... healthy... **HEALTHY!**” (*both arms up strong on the last one*)

TUESDAY · Water in My Cup

Today's words: water (*healthy comes back every day*)

Grab: a bottle of **water** and a bottle of **fizzy drink** in the Magic Box; a bag of sugar cubes (count ten out beforehand and hide them in your pocket); a clear cup, a small jug, a tray; the tea towel.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Box chant. Shake — this one *sloshes*. Hold it to your ear and slosh it again.

EVERYONE “What’s in the box? What’s in the box?”

Lift out the water bottle. Then the fizzy bottle. Stand them side by side on the tray, in the middle, where everybody can see.

TEACHER “Two drinks. Which one do I drink **every day**?” (*hand hovers over each in turn — wait*)

“**Water!**” Everyone drinks from a pretend cup with a long “**aaah**”.

4 MIN TEACH · WATER

Pour water from the jug into the clear cup, slowly, so they hear it. Hold it up to the window.

Water is clear. (*hold the cup up to the light*)

Water is cool. (*touch the cup to your cheek, shiver*)

I drink my water... (*one long drink*)

Aaaaah! (*whole body relaxes*)

Every child gets a real sip if you have cups — ten seconds each, and it is the whole lesson. Littles say “**Water!**” and drink; Bigs say “**I drink my water.**”

Now the fizzy bottle. Take the sugar cubes out of your pocket and stack them one at a time beside it, counting out loud together: “**One... two... three...**” all the way to ten. Everybody gasps at the tower.

Teacher fails: “I am thirsty! I will just eat these ten sugar lumps for my breakfast.” Lift one towards your mouth. Wait for the roar, then put it down and drink the water instead.

3 MIN GAME · COUNT THE SUGAR CUBES

“One, two, three — eyes on me!” Bottles in the middle, sugar cubes in a dish, a numbered card face down under each bottle. “**How much sugar is hiding in this one?**”

A child stacks the cubes in front of one bottle while the class counts. Then turn the card over and check together. Water: **zero** — everybody cheers. Fizzy drink: a tower — everybody gasps. Five bottles: water, milk, juice, fizzy drink, sports drink. Then everyone drinks a cup of water together.

1 MIN CLOSE

EVERYONE “Water... water... **WATER!**” (*both hands fly up on the last one*)

Today's song moment: chorus → **Tuesday's verse** “Water, water, clear and cool, / fill my cup at home and school!” → chorus. On “hip hip hooray” the cup hands go straight up.

WEDNESDAY · Listen to the Crunch

Today's words: crunchy (*healthy · water come back*)

Grab: the **crunchy tray** in the Magic Box — celery, carrot, cucumber and an apple, washed and whole; one soft thing for the contrast (a marshmallow, or a slice of soft bread); a chopping board; wipes.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Box chant. Shake — a dry, woody *knock*. Sniff the lid: it smells green.

EVERYONE “What’s in the box? What’s in the box?”

Peek in. Don’t show them yet. Reach in and **snap** the celery *inside* the closed box, right by their ears.

TEACHER “Did you HEAR that?” (*snap it again, louder*) “That is a **crunchy** food!”

Everyone takes a huge pretend bite and crunches with their whole body. **“Crunchy!”**

4 MIN TEACH · CRUNCHY

One at a time onto the board. Snap each one loudly, right in front of them, and name it.

Celery — SNAP! (*break it in two*)

Carrot — CRUNCH! (*bite it*)

Cucumber — CRUNCH! (*bite it*)

Apple — CRUNCH! (*the loudest one of all*)

All crunchy. All **healthy**. (*strong arms*)

Now the marshmallow. Bite it. Silence. Hold your ear out to the class and look confused. **“No crunch. That one is soft.”**

Littles say **“Crunchy!”** with the big bite; Bigs say **“The carrot is crunchy.”** and **“The marshmallow is soft.”**

Teacher fails: bite the marshmallow and shout **“CRUNCH!”** with enormous satisfaction. Insist. Chew it again and listen hard. Let them correct you twice.

3 MIN GAME · THE CRUNCH GAME

“One, two, three — eyes on me!” Everybody closes their eyes and cups their ears. **“Listen... what am I eating?”** (*bite one food, right by the circle*)

Eyes open. Hands up. **“Carrot!”** Bigs: **“I think it is the carrot.”** Six rounds: celery, carrot, cucumber, apple, the soft marshmallow (a trick round — **“No crunch!”**), and one last mystery. Then a Big does the biting and the class guesses.

Any child who wants a taste gets one — that is the point of the tray. Wipes on standby, and check your allergy list before Wednesday.

1 MIN CLOSE

EVERYONE “Crunch... crunch... CRUNCHY!” (*one enormous bite of the air*)

THURSDAY · Pack My Lunchbox

Today's words: sweet (*healthy · water · crunchy all come back*)

Grab: an **empty lunchbox** in the Magic Box; the food cards from print pack page 14 plus last week's five-food-group cards; one wrapped **sweet**; a basket for the relay.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

Box chant. Shake — nothing. Not a sound. Look worried and shake it again.

EVERYONE "What's in the box? What's in the box?"

Lift out the lunchbox. Open it. Turn it upside down. Nothing falls out.

TEACHER "My lunchbox is **empty**! Who will help me fill it?" (*hold it open towards the circle*)

Every hand goes up. Then reach into your pocket and hold up the one wrapped **sweet**. Everybody says the word: "**Sweet!**"

4 MIN TEACH · SWEET, AND WHAT GOES IN THE BOX

The lunchbox sits open in the middle. Last week's five food groups, one at a time.

Something from the **fruit**... (*a child puts an apple card in*)

Something **green** and crunchy... (*celery goes in*)

Some **bread** or rice... (*in it goes*)

Something to make me **strong**... (*egg or fish*)

And my **water**! (*the bottle goes in last, with a cheer*)

Now hold the sweet over the open box, and wait. "**Every day? ... or sometimes?**"

Littles shout "**Sweet!**" and rub their tummy; Bigs say the frame: "**Sweets are sometimes food.**"

Teacher fails: fill the whole lunchbox with sweets, snap the lid shut and pat it proudly — "Perfect lunch!" Hold the pose. Wait for them to unpack you.

3 MIN GAME · PACK MY LUNCHBOX RELAY

"One, two, three — eyes on me!" Food cards at one end of the carpet, the open lunchbox at the other.

"**Fetch me ONE food — and tell me its group!**"

Each child runs, chooses a card, brings it back and names it: "**Apple — fruit!**" Bigs add "**An apple is healthy.**" Anyone who brings a **sometimes** food holds it up while the whole class chants "**Some-TIMES!**" — then it goes back in the basket, not the box. Finish by closing the lid together: "**Lunchtime!**"

1 MIN CLOSE

EVERYONE "Sweet... sometimes... **HEALTHY** every day!" (*both arms up strong on the last word*)

FRIDAY · Climb High & Share · 重阳节

Today's words: healthy · water · crunchy · sweet · share — the whole week

Grab: 重阳糕 cut into small pieces on a plate, a **chrysanthemum** in a jar and a walking stick; every prop from the week; 王维's poem printed big; the "My Healthy Lunchbox" sheets (page 16) and the awards (page 17); somewhere to climb.

2 MIN MAGIC BOX HOOK

The box comes out fat, rattling, and smelling of cake. **"Today the box is FULL! What did we learn this week?"** Pull the props out one at a time and hold each up in silence — they will supply the word before you can.

Apple → **"Healthy!"** · Water bottle → **"Water!"** · Celery → **"Crunchy!"** · Lollipop → **"Sweet — sometimes!"** Last out: the chrysanthemum, the walking stick and the 重阳糕. **"重阳节!"**

4 MIN TEACH · SHARE

Hold the plate of cake in both hands. Don't eat any. Turn to the child beside you and hold it out.

One for **me...** (*hand on your own chest*)

and one for **you.** (*hold the plate out with both hands*)

I **share** my food. (*both hands push the plate forward*)

Thank you! (*小手合十 — hands together, small bow*)

The plate goes all the way round the circle, hand to hand, and **nobody eats yet.** Every child says **"Share!"** as they pass it on; Bigs say **"I share my food with my friend."**

Today 重阳节 is also 老人节, Elders' Day — so the cake is not for us. Wrap a piece for each 爷爷奶奶 while they watch.

Teacher fails: take the plate back, sit down and eat the whole lot yourself with your back to them. Wait. Being told off for not sharing is the best English lesson of the week.

3 MIN GAME · 登高 — CLIMB HIGH, THEN SHARE

Coats on, walking stick at the front, and up we go. **"Climb, climb, climb — up we go!"** At the top, out of breath, sit and read 王维's poem: 独在异乡为异客, / 每逢佳节倍思亲。 / 遥知兄弟登高处, / 遍插茱萸少一人。

Then ask, quietly: **"谁不在这? Who do you wish were here?"** Let them answer in whichever language comes. Then down the hill, and the 重阳糕 goes round: **"Share!"** Raining? Climb the school stairs, counting each step, and read the poem on the landing.

1 MIN CLOSE + LUNCHBOX FINALE

Hand out the "My Healthy Lunchbox" sheets: every child draws the food they would pack, you scribe their line, and it goes home today with an award.

EVERYONE "Crunchy... healthy... WATER! And I SHARE!" (*big bite · strong arms · cup hands up high · both hands offered out*)

★ Songbook · “Every Day or Sometimes?”

Ukulele · **C** (0003) **F** (2010) **G7** (0212) **Am** (2000) · strum: Down · Down · Down-Up

Chorus — every single day

- C** Crunch, crunch, crunch — an **F** apple a day! **C** (*big bite, then CRUNCH*)
F Water in my **C** cup — hip hip **G7** hooray! **C** (*drink, then both hands up*)
C Sweeties are for sometimes, **F** not for every **Am** day, (*waggle one finger, slowly*)
F Healthy food **C** helps me **G7** grow and play! **C** (*strong arms, then run on the spot*)

One new verse each morning

Monday · Every Day or Sometimes?

- C** Healthy food makes me strong, **G7** eat it up **C** all day long!

Tuesday · Water in My Cup

- C** Water, water, clear and cool, **G7** fill my cup **C** at home and school!

Wednesday · Listen to the Crunch

- C** Carrot, celery, apple too, **G7** CRUNCH! goes the food **C** when I chew!

Thursday · Pack My Lunchbox

- Am** Sweeties are sweet but not every day, **G7** sometimes food — **C** put it away!

Friday · Climb High & Share

- C** One for me and one for you, **G7** share the cake — **C** that's what we do!

Each day: **chorus** → **today's verse** → **chorus**. On Friday sing the whole thing top to bottom — that finale *is* the week's review.

Am is one finger — the same finger C uses, moved across to the G string, second fret. It appears exactly twice: once in the chorus, once on Thursday. Lean back on it; that is the “sometimes” line. If your fingers get stuck, put the uke down and clap the chorus — the CRUNCH lands either way.